ERA 21

A Nation in Turmoil

1960 – 1975

The counterculture · feminism · the rights revolution · the environment

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did the spirit of protest in the 1960s expand the struggle for rights and change American culture?

KEY TERMS

The counterculture · women's liberation · the Chicano Movement · AIM · Stonewall · the environmental movement

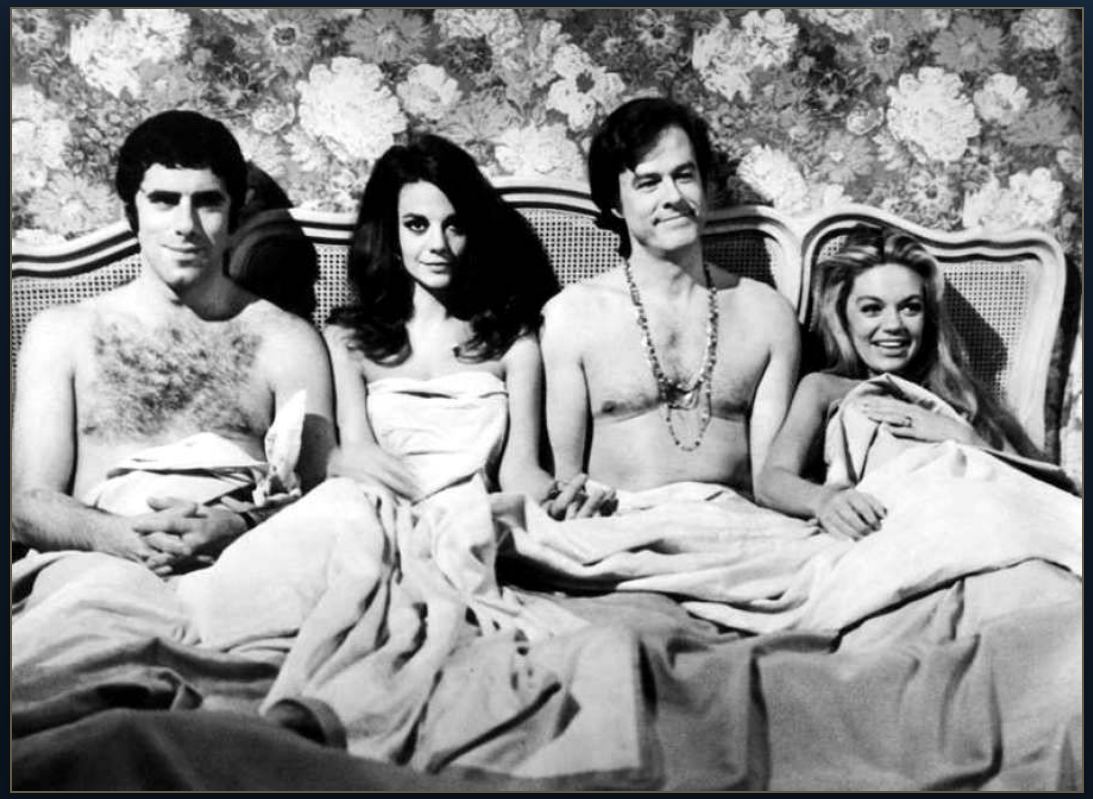
ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 8.11–8.13 · AMSCO Ch. 8.11–8.13

A RISING GENERATION DEMANDS CHANGE

The Age of Protest

The Counterculture



- A youth **counterculture** rejected the conformity of their parents.
- **Hippies** embraced peace, rock music, communal living, and the **sexual revolution**.
- The **New Left** and events like Woodstock (1969) defined the era.

The Women's Movement

- **Betty Friedan's *The Feminine Mystique*** sparked a new **women's liberation** movement.
- **NOW** fought for equality; the **Equal Rights Amendment** and **Title IX** followed.
- In **Roe v. Wade** (1973), the Court recognized a constitutional right to privacy.



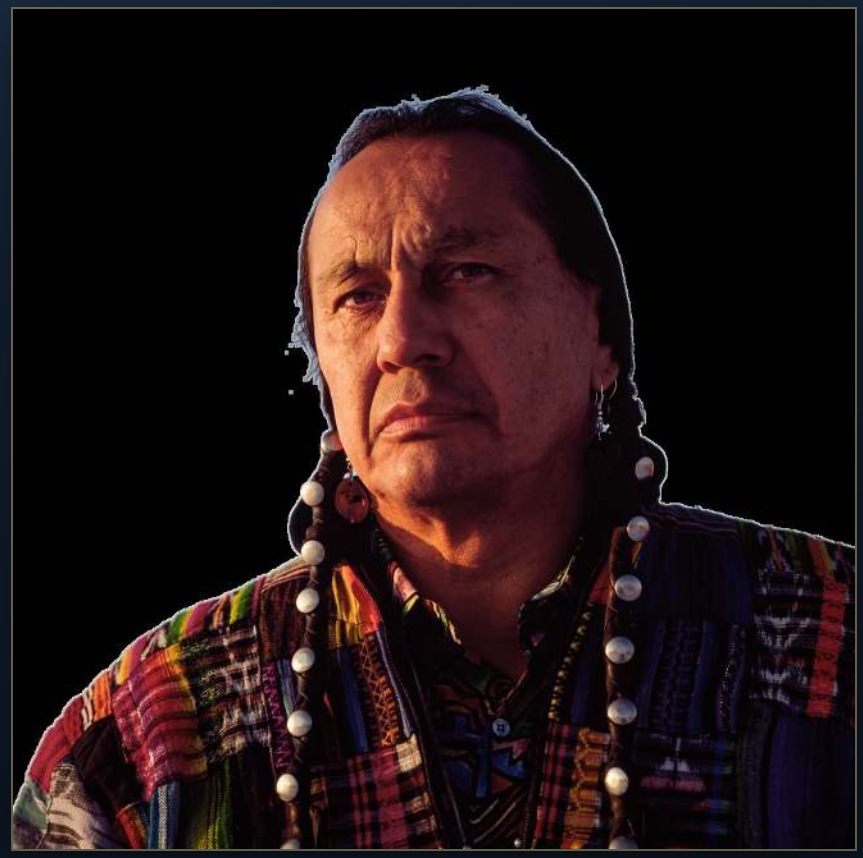
The Chicano Movement



- Mexican Americans organized for rights, recognition, and fair treatment.
- **Cesar Chavez** led the **United Farm Workers** in strikes and grape boycotts.
- The **Chicano Movement** built pride and political power.

The American Indian Movement

- Native activists founded the **American Indian Movement** (**AIM**).
- Led by figures like **Russell Means**, they occupied Alcatraz and **Wounded Knee**.
- They demanded treaty rights, sovereignty, and 'Red Power.'



The Gay Rights Movement



- In 1969, patrons fought back against a police raid at the **Stonewall** Inn.
- The uprising launched the modern **gay liberation** movement.
- Activists demanded dignity, equality, and an end to discrimination.

The Environmental Movement

- **Rachel Carson's *Silent Spring*** (1962) exposed the dangers of pesticides.
- The first **Earth Day** (1970) drew millions of Americans.
- The new **EPA** and the Clean Air and Water Acts protected the environment.



KEY TAKEAWAYS

A Nation in Turmoil

1. A youth **counterculture** and the **New Left** challenged mainstream values and the Vietnam War.
2. The **civil rights model** inspired new movements—**women's liberation**, the **Chicano Movement**, **AIM**, and **gay rights**.
3. The **environmental movement**—from **Silent Spring** to **Earth Day**—launched a lasting green awakening.

DISCUSS & APPLY

A Nation in Turmoil

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

COMPARISON

Compare how different groups adapted the tactics of the **civil rights movement** to their own struggles.

CAUSATION

Explain how the **counterculture** challenged mainstream American values.

CONTINUITY & CHANGE

How did the **rights revolution** of the 1960s reshape American society and law?

Up next — **Class 62: The Conservative Resurgence** (Reagan & the New Right)